

FRAUDSTERS PLAN FOR THE SALE, TOO

"Every festive season sees a sharp spike in online shopping, and fraudsters plan around this surge just as much as brands do. This year, we are seeing increasingly convincing scams, from fake shopping websites promoted through social media and search ads to impersonation scams where fraudsters pose as friends or relatives in urgent need of a payment. Consumers can easily be caught off guard when a familiar-looking website or a trusted name is used to create a sense of urgency. Smartphones are increasingly becoming the first point of vulnerability, with a single tap on a malicious link or an unverified app potentially putting sensitive information and transactions at risk. Our advice to consumers this festive season is simple: shop only through verified apps or official brand websites, avoid clicking on shopping links from unknown messages or advertisements, and always verify payment requests directly with the person concerned. Consumers should also remember that no legitimate bank or business will ask for their UPI PIN or OTP.

Awareness remains the first line of defence, but protection also matters when prevention fails. As digital fraud becomes increasingly sophisticated, solutions such as OneAssist's UPI Fraud Cover can provide an added layer of financial protection along with end-to-end claims support, helping consumers navigate the aftermath of fraud with greater confidence."

– ABHISHEK MAHESHWARI
CEO, OneAssist



A FEW SECONDS OF VERIFICATION

"India's rapid shift towards digital commerce has made holiday shopping more convenient, but it has also created a larger attack surface for cybercriminals. During the festive season, scammers increasingly exploit consumer urgency through fake discounts, phishing links, fraudulent websites and impersonation scams. Consumers need to recognise that cybersecurity is now an essential part of digital financial hygiene. Before making any transaction, verify the website and seller, avoid unsolicited links and never share OTPs, passwords or banking credentials. At the same time, businesses must strengthen their security infrastructure and keep customers informed about emerging threats. The festive season should be about convenience and celebration—not compromised accounts or financial loss. A few seconds of verification can prevent a significant cyber incident. In today's digital economy, staying secure is not optional; it is a shared responsibility."

– SANJIV KELA, DIRECTOR
Net Protector Cyber Security



DON'T LET URGENCY WIN

"The holiday shopping season brings a surge in online activity, and scammers are quick to exploit the urgency around limited-time deals. Consumers should be cautious of deep discounts, unsolicited messages, fake delivery updates and links offering exclusive offers or refunds. Always verify the website or seller before making a purchase, and avoid entering banking or card details through links received over SMS, email or social media. It is also wise to have an additional security layer on your mobile, such as CYBX, which alerts users to potentially malicious links and flags suspicious apps. Its embedded cyber-fraud insurance also provides an added layer of financial protection in the event of a scam. Most importantly, do not let urgency override caution. If an offer seems too good to be true, take a moment to verify it through the brand's official website or app."

– NEEHAR PATHARE
MD, CEO & CIO, 63SATS Cybertech